# Georgia Financial Questions & Answers

**Q1: What is Georgia's current individual income tax structure?**

A: Georgia transitioned from a progressive bracket system to a flat individual income tax structure. For the current tax period, individual income is taxed at a flat rate of 5.39%.

**Q2: How are property taxes structured and assessed in Georgia?**

A: Property taxes are levied by local county and municipal governments based on an assessed value equal to 40% of the property's fair market value, multiplied by the locally established millage rate.

**Q3: What is the state sales tax baseline in Georgia?**

A: The state sales tax rate is 4.0%. However, local counties frequently add local option sales taxes (LOST, HOST, or SPLOST) for education and infrastructure, bringing combined total rates to 6.0% to 8.9%.

**Q4: Does Georgia offer specialized tax exclusions for retirees?**

A: Yes, Georgia offers robust retirement income exclusions. For individuals aged 62 to 64, up to $35,000 of retirement income is exempt. For residents aged 65 and older, up to $65,000 per person ($130,000 for couples) can be excluded from state income tax.

**Q5: Does Georgia levy an estate or inheritance tax?**

A: No, Georgia has completely repealed its estate tax framework and does not levy an inheritance tax, matching federal guidelines without separate state wealth transfers.

## Local Cost of Living (COL) Comparison Index

This comparative framework provides an institutional baseline indexing living costs relative to the national average (set at 100.0).

| State Jurisdiction | Composite COL Index | Housing Cost Metric | State Income Tax Burden |
|---|---|---|---|
| Colorado | 105.5 | 118.2 | 4.40% Flat Rate |

| State Jurisdiction | Composite COL Index | Housing Cost Metric | State Income Tax Burden |
|---|---|---|---|
| Connecticut | 114.8 | 124.6 | 3.00% – 6.99% Progressive |
| Delaware | 100.8 | 101.4 | 2.20% – 6.60% Progressive |
| Florida | 102.1 | 108.5 | 0.00% (None) |
| Georgia | 94.2 | 86.7 | 5.39% Flat Rate |

*Source: Aggregated regional financial metrics adjusted for the 2026 fiscal period.*

This is for informational purposes only. For medical advice or diagnosis, consult a professional. AI responses may include mistakes.